

H/O – Georgia CNA Scope of Practice

Day 5 | GA Healthcare Training & Consulting | Nurse Aide Training Program

Name: _____ Date: _____

What Is Scope of Practice?

Scope of practice defines the tasks and responsibilities a CNA is legally authorized to perform under Georgia law and the supervision of a licensed nurse. Performing tasks outside of scope can result in disciplinary action, loss of certification, or harm to residents.

Georgia CNA Scope of Practice

Within CNA Scope of Practice	OUTSIDE CNA Scope of Practice
✓ Measuring and recording vital signs	X Administering medications of any kind
✓ Assisting with ADLs (bathing, grooming, dressing)	X Performing sterile wound care or dressing changes
✓ Transporting residents; assisting with mobility	X Inserting or removing catheters
✓ Collecting specimens as directed by nurse	X Interpreting lab results or diagnostic findings
✓ Reporting observations and changes to the nurse	X Giving medical advice or diagnosis
✓ Performing ROM exercises as directed	X Initiating or discontinuing treatments
✓ Documenting care provided accurately	X Applying or removing restraints without order
✓ Supporting residents with nutrition and hydration	X Adjusting oxygen flow rates

Key Legal Principles

- Negligence: Failing to perform a duty a reasonable CNA would perform in a similar situation.
- Malpractice: A professional's deviation from the standard of care causing harm.
- False Imprisonment: Physically restraining or confining a resident without legal authority.
- Mandatory Reporting: CNAs are legally required to report suspected abuse, neglect, and exploitation.

HIPAA & Confidentiality

- Never share protected health information (PHI) without resident consent.
- Do not discuss residents in hallways, elevators, or public areas.
- Social media posts about residents — even without names — can violate HIPAA.
- PHI includes name, diagnosis, room number, and any identifying information.

Scenario Review

A nurse asks you to change a wound dressing while she helps another resident. What do you do?

List 3 tasks outside the Georgia CNA scope of practice:
